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NATIONAL SECURITY AGENCY
SIGNALS INTELLIGENCE DIRECTORATE — SPECIAL COLLECTION SERVICE

MEMORANDUM FOR THE RECORD

SUBJECT: OPERATION SILENT ORACLE — PHASE III ASSESSMENT AND TARGET PACKAGE REVIEW

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1. PURPOSE

This memorandum documents the findings of the Phase III operational assessment of OPERATION SILENT ORACLE, a Signals Intelligence (SIGINT) collection initiative targeting foreign adversarial communications infrastructure designated under NSA Program Code 7741-ALPHA. This document is authorized for distribution to cleared personnel with verified TALENT KEYHOLE and BYEMAN accesses only.

2. BACKGROUND

OPERATION SILENT ORACLE was initiated pursuant to Executive Order 12333 and relevant provisions of the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act (FISA), Title 50 U.S.C. §§ 1801–1885c. Phase I and Phase II collection activities concluded on schedule with target yield assessed at 94.3% of projected SIGINT value. Phase III represents the final analytical consolidation phase prior to product dissemination to policymaker consumers.

3. KEY FINDINGS

- (a) SIGINT collection assets confirmed continued operation of adversarial communication nodes at previously identified geographic coordinates. Specific coordinates and facility identifiers are contained in Annex B (CODEWORD) and are not reproduced in this document.
- (b) Technical collection against TARGET ECHO-7 produced 14,847 intercepts during the reporting period. Of these, 3,291 were assessed as PRIORITY INTELLIGENCE REQUIREMENTS (PIR) relevant to INDICATIONS AND WARNING (I&W) objectives.
- (c) Cryptanalytic processing of collected COMINT reveals that the adversary has implemented updated encryption protocols, designated internally as PROTOKOL-9. NSA/CSS cryptanalytic teams have achieved partial penetration of PROTOKOL-9. Full details are contained in CODEWORD annex.

4. OPERATIONAL SECURITY ASSESSMENT

An operational security (OPSEC) review of current collection methodologies was conducted by the Special Security Officer (SSO) in coordination with the NSA Inspector General's office. The review concluded that existing access controls and compartmentalization procedures remain adequate. No evidence of adversarial awareness of collection activities was identified during the review period. Personnel with access to this program are reminded of their obligations under SF-312 and applicable non-disclosure agreements. Unauthorized disclosure of program details constitutes a violation of 18 U.S.C. § 798 and may result in criminal prosecution.

5. PERSONNEL ACCESS ROSTER (PARTIAL — SEE ANNEX A FOR COMPLETE LIST)

NAME	GRADE	ORG CODE	ACCESS LEVEL	DATE BRIEFED
	SES-3	S2C1	TS/SCI/TK/BY	
	GS-15	S2C2	TS/SCI/TK	
	GS-14	S2C2	TS/SCI	
	GS-13	S2C3	TS/SCI	
	CTR	S2CX	TS/SCI	

Names redacted per Privacy Act of 1974, 5 U.S.C. § 552a. Access complete roster via SIPRNet: NSA-SCS-ROSTER-7741A

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7. INTELLIGENCE COMMUNITY COORDINATION

This assessment has been coordinated with the following Intelligence Community elements: Central Intelligence Agency (CIA/DO), Defense Intelligence Agency (DIA/J2), Federal Bureau of Investigation Counterintelligence Division (FBI/CD), and National Reconnaissance Office (NRO/SIGINT). All elements have concurred with the findings contained herein. CIA submitted a formal dissent on Paragraph 3(c) regarding the timeline for full PROTOKOL-9 penetration; dissent text is contained in Annex C.

ANNEX D — RECOVERED IDENTIFIER STRING (SIGINT PRODUCT)

The following identifier string was recovered from adversarial communication intercept NSA-SIGINT-2024-INT-00391. The string is assessed with HIGH CONFIDENCE to represent a machine-generated authentication token used by TARGET ECHO-7 for session verification. Full cryptanalytic context is contained in Annex B (CODEWORD). The string value has been partially redacted below in accordance with NSA/CSS OPSEC directive 12-04 pending full cryptanalytic exploitation.

RECOVERED IDENTIFIER — PARTIAL REDACTION APPLIED — REF: NSA-SCS-OPSEC-12-04

IDENT_STRING: [REDACTED]

Cryptanalytic status: PARTIAL EXPLOIT — See Annex B (CODEWORD) for exploitation details.
Disposition: Retained in NSA/CSS SIGINT Repository pending Phase IV review.

ANNEX E — PROGRAM REVIEW SCHEDULE

EVENT	DATE	VENUE	ACTION OFFICER
PHASE IV KICKOFF BRIEF	15 APRIL 2024	NSA HQ ROOM 2W099	S2C DIVISION CHIEF
CONGRESSIONAL NOTIFICATION	01 MAY 2024	SSCI / HPSCI STAFF	NSA GENERAL COUNSEL
FINAL PRODUCT DISSEMINATION	30 JUNE 2024	IC DISTRIBUTION	S2C PRODUCTION CHIEF
CLASSIFICATION REVIEW	14 MARCH 2029	NSA/CSS OCA	CLASSIFICATION MGMT

SIGNATURE OF ORIGINATING OFFICER
[REDACTED] / S2C DIVISION CHIEF

DATE
14 MARCH 2024

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